

NIGEL D. GRAY

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Education

Ph.D. Harvard University	2029 (expected)
<i>Human Development, Learning, & Teaching</i> (Field Course: Adolescent Development)	
M.Ed. Harvard University	2022
<i>Education Policy and Analysis</i>	
B.Sc. University of London	2019
<i>Economics and Management</i> (First Class Honors, Valedictorian - Class of 2019)	
Honors: Highest Marks Worldwide, Core Management Concepts (2018) Top 5 Highest Aggregate Score Worldwide (2017, 18, 19)	

Publications

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Gray, N. (2023). *The Invisible Hurdle: Hidden Costs for First-Time, International, Graduate Students in the United States*. *Journal of International Students*, 13, 42–47.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Gray, N., & Hill, N. E. (2026). *Balancing Aspiration and Obligation: Gendered Cultural Scripts and Adolescents' Educational Pathways* (Revise & Resubmit). *Youth & Society*.

Gray, N., & Hill, N. E. (2026). *From Believing to Becoming: Longitudinal Associations of Adolescent Identity, Self-Efficacy, and Pathways Into STEM* (Revise and Resubmit). *Journal of Educational Psychology*.

Do, M. H., Gray, N., & Hill, N. E. (2026). *Forecasting an Uncertain Future: How Expectancies of Future Instability Evolve From Adolescence to Adulthood* (Revise and Resubmit). *Developmental Psychology*.

Gray, N., & Hill, N. E. (2026). *Whose Future is it Anyway?: Adolescents' Perceptions of Parental Expectations and Their Implications for Future Planning and Mental Health* (Manuscript in Preparation).

REPORTS

Gray, N., & Atapattu, U. (2021). *Gender-Responsive Budgeting: Evaluating Key Performance Indicators*. Verité Research.

Gray, N. (2020). *NLET Youth in Sri Lanka: A Constrained Optimization Problem*. In *Improving Youth Employment and Entrepreneurship in Sri Lanka: Insights and Strategies*. Verité Research.

Conference Presentations

European Association for Research on Adolescence. Utrecht, Netherlands	2026
<i>Parental Expectations, Altruistic Purpose, and Adolescent Mental Health</i> [Poster].	
International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development. Incheon, South Korea	2026
<i>High Hopes, Hefty Responsibilities: How Adolescents Internalize Future Opportunities Amidst Parental Expectations</i> [Symposium Paper].	
<i>From Believing to Becoming: Longitudinal Associations of Adolescent Identity, Self-Efficacy, and Pathways into STEM</i> [Poster].	
Society for Research in Child Development. Minneapolis, MN	2025
<i>Parenting, Mental Health, & Envisioning a Meaningful Future Among Sri Lankan Youth</i> [Symposium Paper].	
European Association for Research on Adolescence. Limassol, Cyprus	2024
<i>From Bias to Performance: Longitudinal Associations of Gender Bias on Efficacy, Identity, and STEM Achievement in a US Sample</i> [Symposium Paper].	
International Society for the Study of Behavioural Development. Lisbon, Portugal	2024
<i>Evolving Perspectives of Pessimism: Insights From a Longitudinal Study Across 16 Years</i> [Symposium Paper].	
Society for Research on Adolescence. Chicago, IL	2024
<i>Pathways to Purpose: Gender Disparities in Parent and Peer Influence on Adolescents' Sense of Purpose</i> [Poster].	

Grants & Fellowships

RESEARCH GRANTS

Harvard Mind Brain Behavior Interfaculty Initiative , Interdisciplinary Mind Grant (\$10,000). <i>Parenting & Adolescents' Mental Health and Envisioning Meaningful Futures: Cross-National Perspectives From Sri Lanka, Vietnam, & China</i> (co-awardee with Mikayla My Do & Yixuan Cui).	2025–2026
Lakshmi Mittal & Family South Asia Institute, Harvard University , Winter Research Grant (\$2,000). <i>Longitudinal Insights of Parental Expectations & Adolescent Mental Health in a Globalized Sri Lanka</i>	2025
Lakshmi Mittal & Family South Asia Institute, Harvard University , Summer Research Grant (\$2,000). <i>Finding Purpose: Gender and Sociocultural Influences on Sri Lankan Adolescents' Educational Experiences.</i>	2024

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

European Association for Research on Adolescence. <i>Early Career Scholar Travel Grant</i> . (\$580).	2026
The Lakshmi Mittal and Family South Asia Institute, Harvard University. <i>Graduate Student Associate</i> .	2025–2026
Harvard Graduate School of Education. <i>Professional Development Grant</i> . (\$1,500).	2024–2025
International Society for the Study of Behavioral Development. <i>Early Career Scholar Travel Grant</i> . (\$2,500).	2024, 2026
London School of Economics. <i>Summer School Scholarship</i> . (\$3,800). 1 of 22 recipients worldwide.	2018

Professional Experience

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Equity in Education Center – Policy and Research Associate	2022–2023
- Facilitated coalition meetings with 20+ partners, supporting collaboration on education equity strategies. - Presented research on school finance inequities at a statewide conference with 300+ attendees.	
Office of Education Policy, University of Arkansas – Summer Research Intern	2022
- Conducted statistical analysis in R and Excel (hypothesis testing, regression, comparisons of treatment/control). - Cleaned and coded large-scale datasets (55,000+ observations, 500+ variables) to prepare for program evaluation.	
Education Redesign Lab, Harvard University – Graduate Research Assistant	2021–2022
- Built an interactive Excel database with 1200+ data points from public and private sources, providing cost estimates for cradle-to-career success planning programs used by district leaders. - Produced data visualizations & literature reviews for company presentations & policy briefs.	
Verité Research – Economics Research Assistant	2019–2021
- Led cross-functional teams of 10 researchers on projects in budget transparency and gender equality. - Produced 300+ infographics translating economic data into evidence-based, actionable insights for policymakers.	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Harvard University – Teaching Fellow	2022 & 2024–Present
- Introduction to Statistical Computing and Data Science in Education. <i>Spring 2026</i> - Human Development, Learning, and Teaching Core Seminar. <i>Spring 2026</i> - Introductory and Intermediate Statistics for Educational Research: Applied Linear Regression. <i>Fall 2025</i> - Developmental Insights: Connecting Human Development Throughlines Across Research & Practice. <i>Fall 2025</i> - Evidence. <i>Summer 2022, 2024; Winter 2026</i>	
University of London – Visiting Lecturer	2019–2021
- Management Science Methods.	

Community Service & Engagement

Harvard University Graduate Student Tennis Club, <i>Tennis Officer</i>	2026–Present
Harvard Graduate School of Education, <i>Student Admissions Ambassador</i>	2023–Present
Pro-bono College and Graduate School Admissions Advisor for First-generation, low-income students	2020–Present
World Economic Forum, <i>Global Shaper</i>	2021–2023